

CURRENT AFFAIRS



PM IN JAPAN



45th WEEK 2016

UPSC

CAPSULE - 3

ALL EXAMS

7th Nov to 13th Nov

JAPAN ... AT A GLANCE

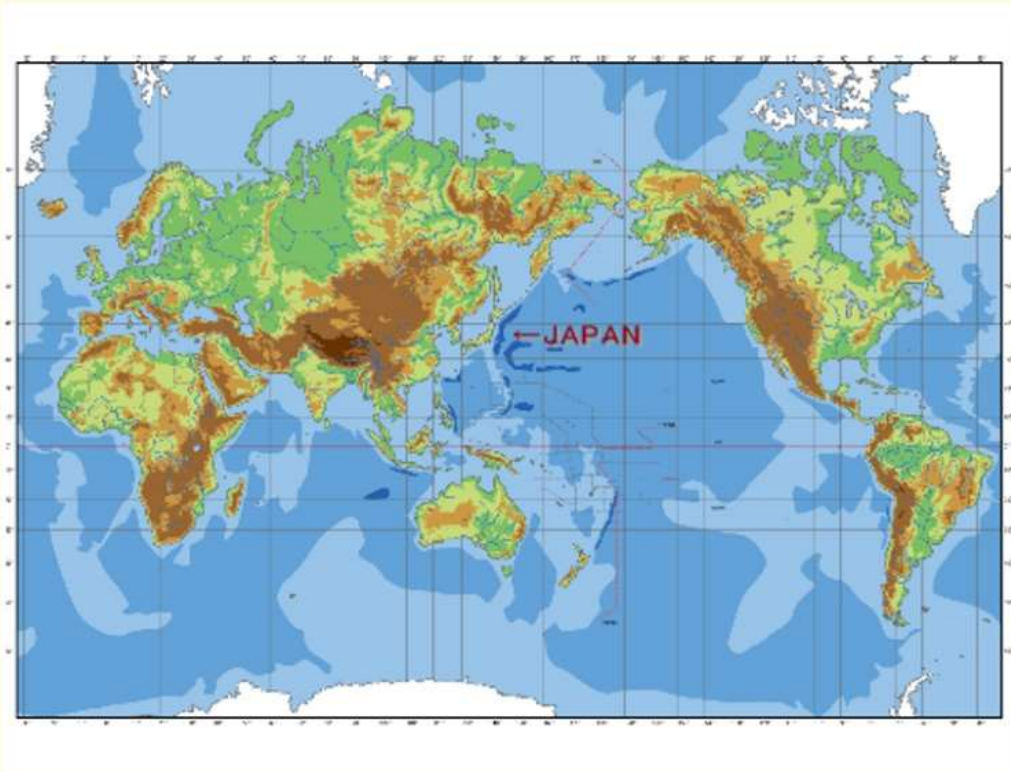


Capital	Tokyo
National Language	Japanese
Ethnic groups	98.5% Japanese 0.5% Korean
Emperor	Akihito
Prime Minister	Shinzo Abe

✓ Government	... Unitary Parliamentary Constitutional Monarchy
✓ Parliament	... Diet
Upper house	... House of Councillors
Lower house	... House of Representatives
✓ Population	... 127 million
✓ Life Expectancy	... around 84 years
✓ HDI	... 0.891 (very high)
✓ Nominal GDP	... 4.5 trillion dollars Third in the world



RESURGENCE OF JAPAN AFTER THE SECOND WORLD WAR



- 1 With the atomic bombing of Hiroshima and Nagasaki, Second World War came to an end in 1945.
- 2 The period from the 1960s to the 1980s was termed as the Japanese post-war economic miracle.
- 3 Japan is at the forefront in Asia, as far as the industrialization is concerned.
- 4 The country recorded growth rates of 7.5% (average) in 1960s and 1970s.
- 5 Japan is the third largest economy by nominal GDP and fourth largest by Purchasing Power Parity. It stands at fourth place as far as exports and imports are concerned. It is a member of G7, G20, OECD.



RELATIONS WITH THE WORLD AS A WHOLE



- 1 Japan followed the policy of **Self-Defence Doctrine** during the first fifty years, but subsequently, announced the change in policy to **Collective Self-Defence Doctrine** in 2015.
- 2 It has got territorial disputes with China on Diaoyu (Senkaku) islands in East China Sea.
- 3 Japan is the key country in Asia Pacific region to “Pivot to Asia” policy of the USA and with the new President-elect, Donald Trump, further policy initiatives are clearly not known.
- 4 It is also looking at business opportunities, because of its stagnant economy primarily due to the greying of the population, as the life expectancy in Japan is the highest at around 84 years.
- 5 USA-India-Japan-Australia and some other countries are expected to have strategic relationship, as per the present foreign policy initiative of USA.



JAPAN AND INDIA ... DURING THE PAST 20 YEARS



- 1 India conducted a nuclear test in 1998.
- 2 Subsequently, Japan suspended economic assistance for three years and had frozen all political exchanges.
- 3 Suspension of economic assistance resulted in halting aid for new projects, suspension of Yen-denominated loans and the imposition of strict controls over technology transfers.
- 4 At the same time, Japan called upon the G8 countries to condemn the Indian and Pakistani nuclear programmes.



JAPAN AND INDIA ... DURING THE PAST 20 YEARS



- 5 In 2008, India concluded a civil nuclear cooperation agreement with the United States of America.
- 6 Japan is insisting on signing NPT, CTBT to sign a civil nuclear agreement with India.
- 7 There is a turnaround during the past two years, which ultimately led to the signing of the civil nuclear deal with India and India is the first non-NPT country with which Japan concluded a civil nuclear cooperation agreement.



PRIME MINISTER IN JAPAN



SALIENT POINTS

India and Japan signed 10 agreements to boost bilateral cooperation

- Most important agreement pertains to “Cooperation in Peaceful Uses of Nuclear Energy”.
- Memorandum of Cooperation on the manufacturing, skill transfer promotion programme, which envisages training 30,000 Indian youth in the Japanese styled manufacturing in the next 10 years.
- MoU was signed between ISRO and JAXA for cooperation in planetary exploration, satellite navigation and space industry promotion.
- MoU signed between NIIF and Japan Overseas Infrastructure Investment Corporation for promoting investment in infrastructure projects in transportation and railways.
- MoU signed between Hyogo and Gujarat to promote mutual cooperation in the fields of business, academics, cultural cooperation, disaster management etc.



AGREEMENT FOR COOPERATION IN PEACEFUL USES OF NUCLEAR ENERGY



WHY JAPAN SIGNED AFTER SEVERAL YEARS?



- 1 India is the first non-NPT country with whom Japan signed a civil nuclear cooperation agreement.
- 2 Japan dithered for several years, but it took this decision, because of vast business opportunities for its firms in India. Other important and interesting point is the US based firms GE as well as Westinghouse have got substantial ownership of Japanese firms.
- 3 Japan badly needed markets after the Fukushima accident and Japan is not in favour of nuclear power plants.
- 4 This agreement was made possible not only because of compulsion of Japanese firms, but also because of bonhomie between Narendra Modi and Shinzo Abe.



AGREEMENT FOR COOPERATION IN PEACEFUL USES OF NUCLEAR ENERGY



WHAT ABOUT TERMINATION CLAUSE BY JAPAN?

- 1 Japan included a note on views and understanding of the civil cooperation agreement, which talks about a “termination clause”.
- 2 The “termination clause” is an emergency clause that allows Japan to invoke suspension of nuclear supplies, if India tests a nuclear weapon and at the same time to contest any compensation claims from India in court.
- 3 India says that this is the view of Japan and not binding on India. India also says that this “termination clause” was recorded in the “views by the Japanese side” considering the special sensitivities, as Japan is the only nation to have suffered a nuclear attack.

Finally, India said that it has not given any additional commitments over the similar agreements signed with the US and other countries.



PRIME MINISTER IN JAPAN



ADDITIONAL POINTS

- 1 The Prime Minister stated that Japan is the natural partner in India's journey of becoming a major centre for manufacturing, investments and knowledge industries. The Prime Minister thanked Shinzo Abe for extending support for India's membership of Nuclear Suppliers Group.
- 2 The Prime Minister stated that the Malabar Naval Exercises underscored the convergence of our strategic interests in the broad expanse of waters of Indo-Pacific.
- 3 In March, 2016 "Visa on Arrival" facility was extended to Japanese Nationals.
- 4 The Prime Minister also stated that India extended long term 10-year visa facility to eligible Japanese business persons.





**INDIA, JAPAN, AND THE U.S. TO PARTICIPATE
IN THE TRILATERAL MALABAR NAVAL EXERCISE**

